

DECISION BRIEF · N8N × STRANDS × AGENTCORE

Don't pick one platform. Build the **stack**.

n8n, Strands, and Bedrock AgentCore aren't competitors — they occupy three different layers of an agent platform. Scored against our six requirements, each wins its own layer, and the right answer composes all three.

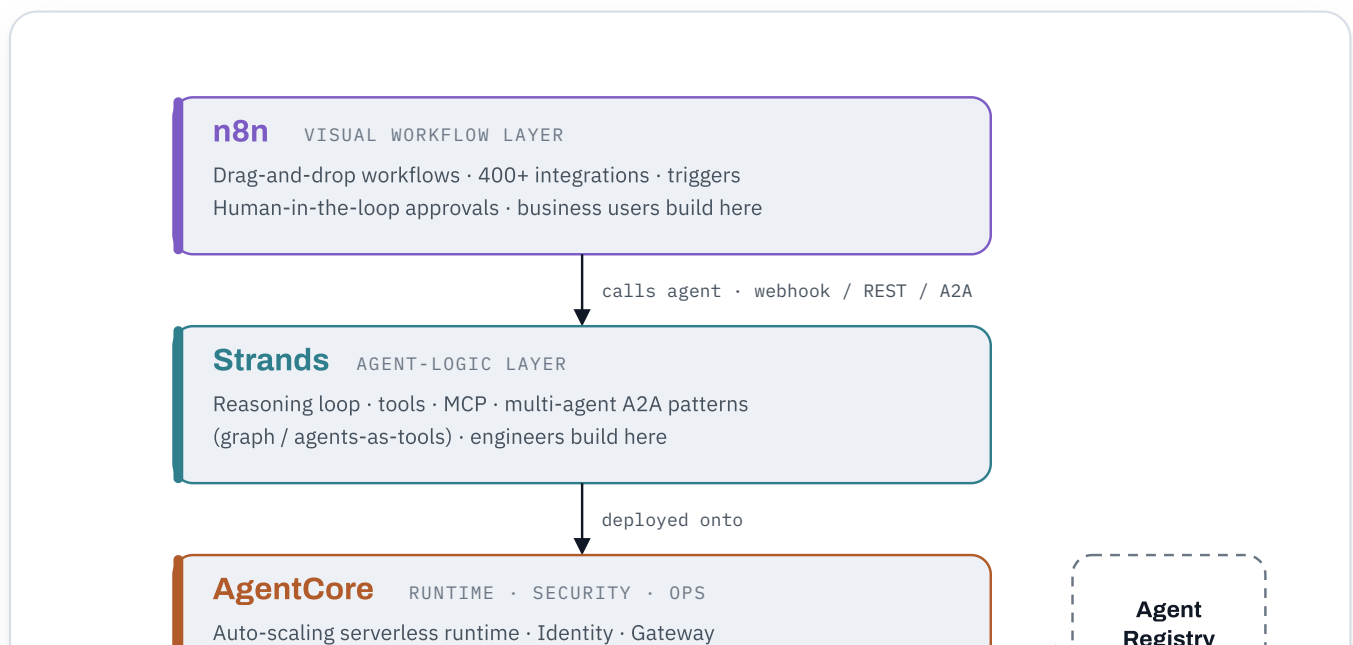
Recommendation:

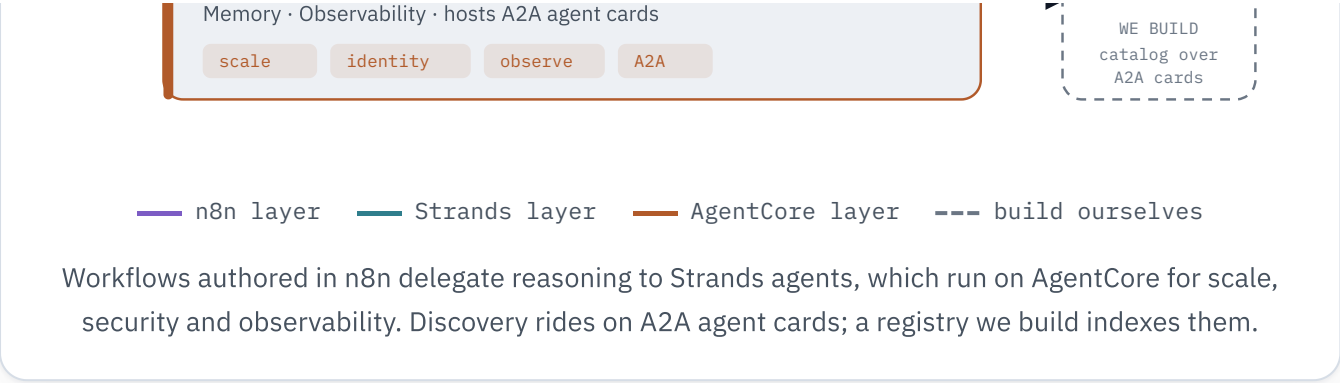
n8n for visual workflows → Strands for agent logic → AgentCore for runtime, security & ops — plus a registry service we build ourselves.

THE RECOMMENDED ARCHITECTURE

Three layers, one platform

Each layer does what it's best at and hands off to the next. The one piece none of the three vendors provides — a centralized agent registry — becomes our differentiator.





SCORECARD

How each layer scores on our six requirements

Rated ★ to ★★★★★ *for that requirement* — not overall. Filled pips = strength. LEAD marks who owns the requirement in the recommended stack.

Requirement	n8n WORKFLOW LAYER	Strands AGENT SDK	AgentCore RUNTIME
Workflow creation visual authoring	LEAD		
A2A — discovery agent cards		LEAD	LEAD
A2A — registry central catalog			GAP — WE BUILD
Security authn · isolation			LEAD
Deployment / auto-scale runtime			LEAD
Agent Ops observability			LEAD

The registry row is the tell: **no vendor provides a centralized agent registry**. Both Strands and AgentCore do discovery via decentralized A2A agent cards served at `/ .well-known/agent-card.json` — a catalog to register,

search and govern agents is something we own.

WHO OWNS WHAT

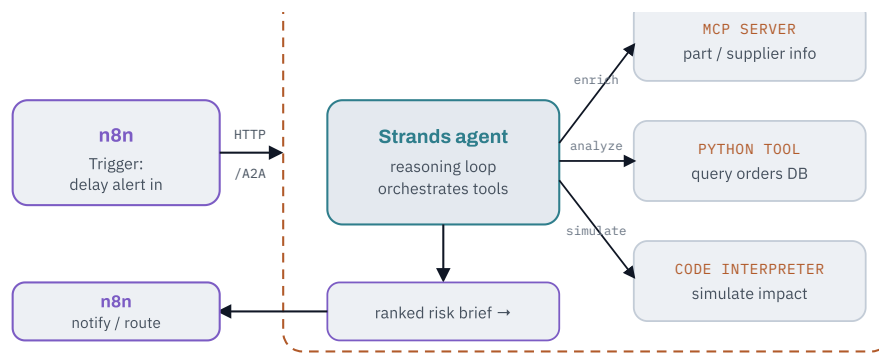
Requirement → layer

WORKFLOW CREATION n8n Visual front door for business workflows; Strands handles code-defined agent sub-workflows.	A2A DISCOVERY Strands + AgentCore Native A2A protocol and agent cards, working across frameworks.
A2A REGISTRY We build it A thin catalog service indexing A2A agent cards — none of the three provides it.	SECURITY AgentCore Identity (OAuth / OIDC / IAM), session isolation, VPC + PrivateLink, Gateway with Cedar policy.
DEPLOYMENT / AUTO-SCALE AgentCore Serverless, session-isolated, multi-region runtime — no clusters to operate.	AGENT OPS AgentCore Decision- and tool-call-level observability plus built-in evaluation against real traffic.

POC WIRING · SUPPLY-CHAIN TRIAGE AGENT

How the layers connect in the 8–10h POC

A concrete slice: a supplier-delay alert flows from an n8n workflow into a Strands agent on AgentCore, which enriches via MCP, queries orders, simulates impact, and returns a ranked risk brief that n8n routes onward.



The agent's reasoning loop and its three tool calls (MCP enrich · orders query · impact simulation) all run inside the AgentCore boundary; n8n owns only the entry trigger and the outbound notification.

KEEP IT HONEST

Four things to decide with eyes open

The registry is on us

Centralized discovery, versioning and governance of agents is white-space across all three. Scope it as a platform component, not an inherited feature.

AWS lock-in at the base

AgentCore ties runtime, security and ops to AWS. Fine given our Bedrock footprint — and n8n + Strands keep the upper layers portable.

n8n at org scale needs the enterprise tier

RBAC / SSO and HA queue-mode (Redis, worker autoscaling) are operational commitments once n8n is the front door for everyone.

A single-vendor alternative exists

Google Vertex AI Agent Builder is more agent-native and visual — but adopting it means leaving our AWS + n8n investment. Not recommended on current evidence.

PREPARED FOR AI-NINJA · AGENT-BUILDING PLATFORM · SUPPLY CHAIN & FINANCE

Sources: AWS (AgentCore GA & A2A runtime support, Oct–Nov 2025), Strands Agents docs (A2A protocol), n8n documentation. Vendor capabilities evolve — reconfirm before final commitment.

